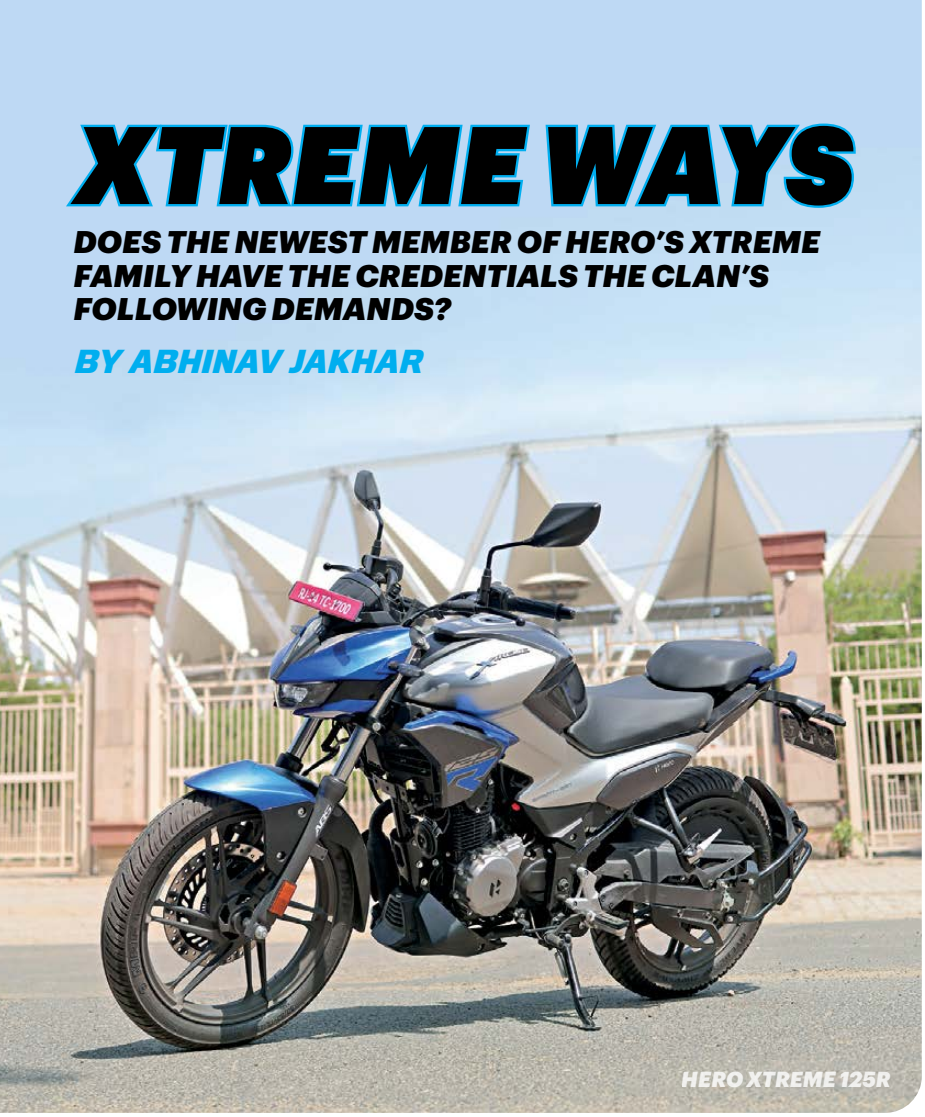
AUTO SPECIAL
FIRST DRIVE & RIDE
MOTORCYCLES

XTREME WAYS

DOES THE NEWEST MEMBER OF HERO'S XTREME FAMILY HAVE THE CREDENTIALS THE CLAN'S FOLLOWING DEMANDS?

BY ABHINAV JAKHAR



HERO XTREME 125R

Hero MotoCorp recently added a new member to its family, and before you make any assumptions, no, we aren't talking about the Mavrick 440. It is the 'other' new motorcycle to come from the home-grown manufacturer's stable—the Xtreme 125R. It is now the smallest member of the Xtreme family. So, where does the 125R fit into the mix?

At first glance, the Xtreme 125R looks quite radical. Take for example the front projector LED headlamps, indicators and that funky headlamp cowl design. The tank extensions, alloy wheel design and extended rear section look rather sleek and sporty. Even subtle nuances like the reflector on the tyre hugger mudguard and well-integrated sari guard really blend in well together. There's a certain confidence in the Xtreme 125R's design language that is hard to miss, and that is a crucial factor when it has to appeal to a buyer who is looking for an all-rounder of sorts.

In terms of features, the biggest talking point has to be the single-channel ABS, a segment-first. In fact, that's not the only segment-topping feature here. The Xtreme 125R also boasts the widest rear tyre in its segment, a 120-section unit. Other than that, the entire lighting setup, front and back, is LED, which is a nice touch. The negative LCD instrument cluster is neat and clean, and displays all sorts of useful information. Hero has equipped the 125R quite well, and this should go a long way in appealing to its target audience.

The Xtreme 125R comes with a 124.7 cc motor that churns out 11.4bhp and 10.5 Nm of torque. Right from the get-go, this engine feels smooth, thanks to the silent cam chain and balancer shaft that Hero has added to make for a vibe-free experience. Although there are some vibes past the 7,000 rpm mark, the acceleration on the whole feels progressive and there isn't a lack of power. The mid-range is where the Xtreme 125R feels at its strongest. The five-speed gearbox operates without much hassle, although it has to be worked a lot if you want a quick overtake. The claimed fuel efficiency figure stands at 66 kmpl, which combined with the 10-litre fuel tank should give the Xtreme 125R a decent amount of range. Hero's commuter with a sporty twist can easily hold speeds of 80 to 90 kmph. The Xtreme 125R is one of those bikes that can be ridden right at the edge, in the sense that all the performance is being used, and it's a good feeling, to say the least. Overall, the engine and gearbox combination is a good one, and the output feels mature.

Engine: 124.7cc single cylinder
Power: 11.4bhp@8,250rpm
Torque: 10.5Nm@6,500rpm
Gearbox: 5-speed
Kerb weight: 136kg
Price: ₹95,000 (ex-showroom)

The Xtreme 125R is based on the same diamond-type frame as its elder sibling—160R. As a result, it is an able handler and feels rather fun around corners. The 276 mm disc at the front and 130 mm drum brake at the rear do a commendable job. The chassis feels very well sorted and provides a lovely balance between agile handling and ride comfort. The Showa rear monoshock must be praised for this, as well as the 37 mm telescopic front fork, which does a more than decent job at making the Xtreme 125R comfortable. All in all, the Xtreme 125R is a capable handler and comes with a respectable amount of ride comfort for daily use. To sum up, the 125R comes in two variants—IBS and ABS—which are priced at Rs 95,000 and 99,500, respectively (ex-showroom). It delivers on being a comfortable, fun-to-ride, stylish and fuel-efficient commuter. ■